interpretations. Copenhagen puts humans, indeed the self, at the very center of the universe, more important than anything else, just as the ancients had it, with everything else revolving around us. This is why quantum physics holds such appeal in "alternative" circles. Rather than giving a humbling and strange vision of the universe, the Copenhagen interpretation makes physics familiar and comfortable. If we are to have any hope of understanding the universe, we must dare to imagine a world that is not bounded by our limited perspective.

But why does any of this matter? If shutting up and calculating works—and it does—then why do physicists need anything else? And why should any of this matter to anyone who isn't a physicist?

It's certainly true that we'll get the same answers when doing quantum-mechanical calculations whether we prefer the Copenhagen interpretation, the many-worlds interpretation, the pilot-wave interpretation, or anything else. Even alternatives to quantum physics, like spontaneous-collapse theories, will give the same answers in nearly every situation. Some people have argued, as Wolfgang Pauli did to Bohm, that, because the different interpretations don't make new predictions, we should just stick with Copenhagen—a silly argument, since you could say "we should just stick with many-worlds" or any other interpretation with that same reasoning.

Others claim that the alternatives to Copenhagen are driven by a desire to make things less weird than Copenhagen makes them out to be, and we should instead embrace the weirdness, that any discomfort with the Copenhagen interpretation is merely a sign of our limited human ability to understand the world of the quantum. This argument would carry more weight if there were no viable alternatives to the Copenhagen interpretation, if its conclusions were forced upon us. But there's another problem with it as well. "All of the proposals we have for solving the measurement problem are weird in one way or another," said David Albert. "Bell's theorem proves they have to be weird.… [But] there's a huge difference between being weird and being incoherent or unintelligible." And, Albert added, many physicists still do not seem to appreciate this point. "Physicists will say,